

Μητρόδωρος ὁ Λαμψακηνός

Metrodorus of Lampsacus the Elder and Anaxagoras

eul_aid: coe

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)
Dialect: [Ἰωνική](#) [Ionic](#)
Domain: [Φιλοσοφία](#) [Philosophy](#)
Format: [Συναγωγή](#) [Collection](#)
Affiliation: [Epicurean](#)

Metrodorus of Lampsacus the Elder was a philosopher from the 5th century BCE during the Classical period of ancient Greece. A native of Lampsacus in Asia Minor, he was a student of the pre-Socratic thinker Anaxagoras. He is called "the Elder" to distinguish him from a later philosopher from the same city who followed Epicurus.

He is historically significant as the first known author to produce a detailed physical, or natural philosophical, interpretation of Homer's poetry. His work, titled **On Homer**, does not survive intact and is known only through fragments and references in later ancient writers. In it, he systematically interpreted the gods, heroes, and events of Homer's epics as allegories for natural elements and principles. For instance, scholars report that he interpreted Achilles as representing the sun and the Trojan War as a conflict between elemental opposites.

This approach was an early attempt to reconcile traditional mythology with the new scientific theories of his time. His allegorical method represents a significant bridge between pre-Socratic physical speculation and literary criticism, influencing later thinkers who sought deeper meanings in poetic texts.

Works (1)

- [Μαρτυρίαι](#) · [Testimonies](#) · 6 passages

Other Epicurean Authors

- [Καρνεῖσκος ὁ Ἐπικούρειος](#) · [Carneiscus the Epicurean](#) · 2 works
- [Διογένης ὁ Οἰνοανδεύς](#) · [Diogenes of Oenoanda](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀνώνυμος Ἐπικούρειος](#) · [Epicurean Anonymous](#) · 2 works
- [Ἐπίκουρος ὁ φιλόσοφος](#) · [Epicurus the Philosopher](#) · 8 works
- [Ἑρμαρχος ὁ Μυτιληναῖος](#) · [Hermarchus of Mytilene](#) · 1 work
- [Φιλόδημος ὁ Γαδαρεύς](#) · [Philodemus of Gadara](#) · 2 works
- [Πολύστρατος ὁ Ἐπικούρειος](#) · [Polystratus the Epicurean](#) · 2 works